

Shilong Xiang

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Education

Wuhan University of Technology, BA in Finance (Transferred)	Sept 2021 – May 2023
University of California, Berkeley, Visiting Student	Jan 2024 – May 2024
University of Minnesota, Twin Cities, BS in Computer Science	Sep 2024 – Present

Research experience

University of Minnesota	Twin Cities, MN, USA
[Deshwal's Lab] Research Intern Mentor: Harry Winston Sullivan Advisor: Aryan Deshwal	Sep 2025 – Present
• Generative model	
[Knowledge Computing Lab] Research Intern Mentor: Janghyeon Lee Advisor: Yao-Yi Chiang	Sep 2024 – Present
• Led the development of WalkCLIP , a multimodal framework that integrates satellite imagery, street-level views, and population dynamics to achieve state-of-the-art urban walkability prediction.	
• Fine-tuned a CLIP-based vision-language model on a dataset using LLM-generated captions to learn walkability-aware visual representations.	
• Designed and implemented a novel Spatially-Aware Feature Enhancement (SAFE) module that aggregates neighborhood features to improve spatial consistency and predictive accuracy.	
• Pioneered the fusion of SAFE-enhanced visual embeddings with non-visual geospatial context from the Population Dynamics Foundation Model (PDFM), capturing a holistic view of the urban environment.	

Publications

Shilong Xiang, JangHyeon Lee, Min Namgung, Yao-Yi Chiang. "WalkCLIP: Multimodal Learning for Urban Walkability Prediction." (Under Submission to AAAI 26 Urban Planning)

Projects

ICBC Credit Suisse FinTech Challenge (Repo)	2023
• Developed a full-stack financial prediction platform, engineering a deep learning model for factor analysis and creating an interactive front-end to visualize real-time prediction results.	
• Enhanced data processing efficiency and model training pipelines, contributing to a solution that secured Third Prize in a competitive FinTech challenge.	

Awards

• UMN MURAJ In-Action Grant Award	2025
• Third Prize of ICBC Credit Suisse FinTech Challenge	2023
• WUT Outstanding Academic Achievement Scholarship	2023, 2022

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, LaTeX